



BEFORE

When Spain lost control of its American colonies, it began to lose its political stability.

REIGN OF ALFONSO XIII

Defeat in the 1898 Spanish-American War << 318–19 damaged Spain's monarchy.

Republican movements pressed for greater democracy, and support for anarchism took root. In response to violent strikes, King Alfonso XIII became increasingly dictatorial. In 1921 Spain was defeated in a **rebellion by tribes in its Moroccan colony**, which aggravated the economic crisis, and domestic violence escalated. In September 1923 **General Miguel Primo de Rivera** led a *coup d'état* and became military dictator until he lost the army's support and resigned in 1930. In 1931 King Alfonso agreed to municipal elections. The



ALFONSO XIII

result was overwhelming majorities for those who were in favor of a republic, and Alfonso was forced into exile. He died in 1941.

SECOND REPUBLIC

The left-wing Second Republic alienated many groups with its reforms. In 1933, a **right-wing election victory** led to a general strike on October 4, 1934 and an armed rising in Asturias, northern Spain. When the left-wing **Popular Front** won the 1936 general election, their radical rhetoric alarmed conservatives. Tension mounted as street battles between rival groups and widespread strikes paralyzed the nation.

ANARCHISM is a political belief that society should have no police, government laws, or other authority.

Spanish Civil War

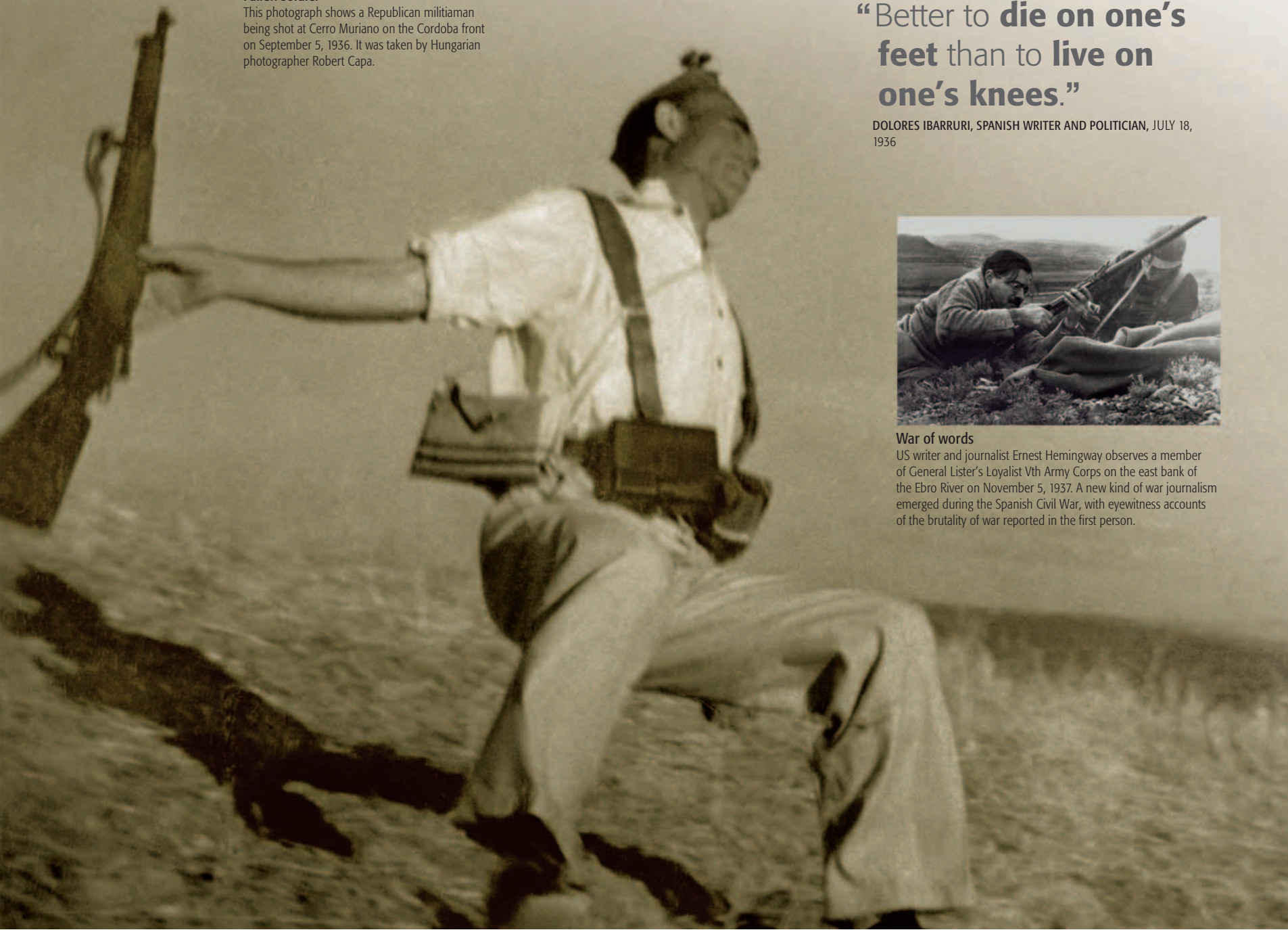
The Spanish Civil War is regarded as the first ideological conflict between international fascism and international communism. Some of the military tactics that were employed during the fighting foreshadowed those later used in World War II.

On February 21, 1936 Spain's new left-wing Popular Front government promised liberty, prosperity, and justice, but some people considered their policies to be too progressive. On July 17 and 18, Spanish military forces based in Morocco revolted against the elected government. They expected little opposition, but supporters of the Second Republic and its government resisted, and Spain found itself in the

grip of civil war. The Republicans received weapons and volunteers from the Soviet Union and Mexico, and aid from supporters of liberal democracy, communism, and the anarchist movement. Left-wing parties, such as the Socialists and the Anti-Stalinist Marxist Party, which was formed in 1935, also supported the government. The insurgents, who became known as the Nationalists, had the backing of monarchists, Catholics, and the Falange

Fallen soldier

This photograph shows a Republican militiaman being shot at Cerro Muriano on the Cordoba front on September 5, 1936. It was taken by Hungarian photographer Robert Capa.



“Better to die on one's feet than to live on one's knees.”

DOLORES IBARRURI, SPANISH WRITER AND POLITICIAN, JULY 18, 1936



War of words

US writer and journalist Ernest Hemingway observes a member of General Lister's Loyalist Vth Army Corps on the east bank of the Ebro River on November 5, 1937. A new kind of war journalism emerged during the Spanish Civil War, with eyewitness accounts of the brutality of war reported in the first person.